

We'll shortly consider some ways of responding to Edwards' argument. But first let's think about how Edwards' argument might be related to an argument for fatalism.

Suppose that someone did not believe in God — and hence rejected premise (2) of Edwards' argument — but did believe that there were truths about all of our future actions. Could they give an argument similar to Edwards' argument?

There are truths
about our future
actions.

We have no
choice about the
past.

If we have no choice
about A, and no
choice about the
connection between
A and B, then we
have no choice about
B.

In the past, God
had
foreknowledge of
our future
actions.

One person who has no trouble rejecting this assumption is the atheist. If God does not exist, then God is not around to know about our future actions. So the Foreknowledge Argument is only a real challenge to free will if you think that God exists.

But could the theist deny this assumption?

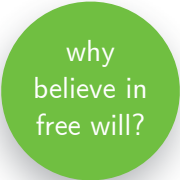
One way to deny it would be to deny the existence of fate — in that case there would be no truths about our actions for God to know. I'll come back to that idea.



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

responding to Edwards' argument. But

We'll shortly consider some ways of

first let's think about how Edwards'

for fatalsn.

argument might be related to an argument

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

actions. Could they give an argument

Suppose that someone did not believe in

there were truths about all our future

similar to Edwards' argument?









axis.tcs.

not exist, then God is not a **div** but a **future action**. So the

For knowledge Argument is only a real challenge to free will if you think that God

One person who has trouble rejecting this assumption is the atheist. If God does

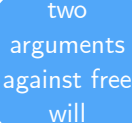
One way to deny it would be to deny the existence of fate—in that case there



would be no truth about our actions for God to know. I'd come back to that idea.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

freedom that comes from fate.



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

either.

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

things as fate, then there is no free will.

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

God only shows up in premises (2) and

with reference to the being of truth about

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

our future actions.



4. If we have no choice about p , and no

that if it is true that I will perform

God knows that in the future I will

2* In the past, there were truths about

0 We have achieved what we

perform a certain action (1,2)

3 We have not the fact that

acaioid.

some action, then I will prefer that



then we have the choice about q.

(3, 4, 5)

all of our activities.

1. We have no direct facts.

will perform various actions.

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

5* We have not decided what the fact

The fatalist argument

There are truths
about our future
actions.

We have no
choice about the
past.

If we have no choice
about A, and no
choice about the
connection between
A and B, then we
have no choice about
B.

In the past, God
had
foreknowledge of
our future
actions.

In the past, God
had
foreknowledge of
our future
actions.